

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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METHODS and MOTIVATION

BEFORE "METHODS" COMES "MOTIVATION"

OUR MESSAGE - REFLECTING ON THE BEHAVIOUR OF THOSE WHO TEND TO PLACE METHODS BEFORE MOTIVATION.

- ▲ **WHEN MOTIVATION IS MISSING / ABSENT THEN MAN TENDS TO TURN TO METHODS AND THEN RELY ON THEM.**
- * Such a reliance on Methods alone is a fallacy that can lead to disappointment and frustration because methods are only effective if they are implemented; and it requires people to do that.
- ▲ **METHODS WITHOUT MOTIVATION IS A VERY POOR SUBSTITUTE.**
- * If people are not motivated / moved to apply those methods then all you have is methods, plans, strategies.
- * If there is little or no motivation, then methods alone are a poor substitute – because they lack the power to perform - to be implemented.
- * **IF THE HEART IS TRULY MOTIVATED TO DO WHAT GOD HAS COMMISSIONED THEN THOSE METHODS, PLANS ARE MORE LIKELY TO BE IMPLEMENTED.**
- ▲ **BUT METHODS ALONE WILL NOT ACCOMPLISH ANY MANDATE.**
- ▲ **MOTIVATION IS THE ENGINE THAT GENERATES ACTION / ACTIVITY.**

THE DANGER

- ▲ **SADLY, THERE IS OFTEN A TENDENCY TO GIVE PRIORITY TO METHODS, STRUCTURE, STRATEGY, PLANS AND THE OVER RELIANCE ON 'THE HOW TO DO IT', RATHER THAN ON THE EMPOWERING FACTOR NECESSARY TO ACHIEVE THOSE AND SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES.**
- ▲ **I HAVE OFTEN FOUND THAT IT IS THE MOTIVATION THAT INSPIRES LEARNING AND DISCOVERY OF 'THE HOW TO' WHILE ACTUALLY ENGAGED IN 'THE DOING'.**
- ▲ **WE MUST AIM AT MOTIVATION BEFORE METHODS, PLANS AND STRATEGIES. – MOTIVATION PRECEDES THESE THINGS.**
- ▲ **PLANS WITHOUT PASSION IS TO ENGAGE IN A FRUITLESS ACTIVITY.**
- ▲ **IF THERE IS LITTLE PASSION IN THE HEART FOR THE WORK AHEAD THEN SUCH PERSONS WILL NOT LAST, THEY WILL EVENTUALLY DISENGAGE OR ABANDON THE WORK ALTOGETHER.**

PASSION IS ESSENTIAL

- ▲ HOW CAN WE POSSESS THOSE THINGS THAT RELATE TO GOD'S KINGDOM **WITHOUT A PASSIONATE HEARTFELT ATTITUDE OF PREPAREDNESS** TO DO WHATEVER IS NECESSARY **FOR AS LONG AS IT TAKES** TO ACCOMPLISH THE TASK GIVEN.
- ▲ **AND THIS ALSO THE SAME FOR US POSSESSING OUR POSSESSIONS**, POSSESSING THOSE THINGS THAT GOD HAS PROMISED US. Example - healing/health, provision, abundant life etc.

HOW TO DESCRIBE PASSION

- ▲ WHAT ARE THE **SIGNS** OR **EVIDENCE** OF **PASSION**?
- * Passion is more than just a desire or an interest or a fascination with something; it is a passionate attitude that desperately wants something that God said needs to be accomplished.
- * **Passion** may be described as any powerful or compelling emotion or feeling, as a love or hate, strong affectionate feeling or desire, affection.
- * **Passion**, an intense emotional state of a love for something and **If you find something that provides you with this feeling of passion, that would be amazing.**

WHAT IS OUR PASSION?

- ▲ WHAT IS IT THAT WE ARE PASSIONATE ABOUT IN RELATION TO GOD AND CHRIST?

POSSESSING THE GOAL – ACHIEVING OUR OBJECTIVE

- * Firstly, we need to know THE **SOURCE** of our **passion**. Where did it originate? From God or from us?
- * However, we must also realise that it will involve us, our heart, emotions, and thoughts as this is where God by the Holy Spirit plants / prompts us with his desires.
- 1. But it is vital that we identify **THE ORIGIN** of that specific desire.
- * Is it from us or from God's Spirit that prompts the heart and inflames the emotions?
Psalms 39:3 My heart was hot within me. While I meditated, the fire burned: I spoke with my tongue: WEB
Psalms 39:3 My heart grew hot within me; whenever I thought of it, the fire burned. Then, [at last,] I let my tongue speak: CJB
- ▲ **PASSION** turns an idea or a thought into a forceful miraculous accomplishment for God, a lasting testimony to God's power and grace.
- ▲ **PASSION** is that feeling that sustains us through all circumstances, disappointments, and failures.
- * But if it is merely from us – then it is more probably a passing interest or a fascination that will not last the pressures of trials.
- 2. We need **TO DIRECT** our passion towards the objective. Direct all your energies that your passion provides **TOWARDS** the target or mandate that God has given you to carry out.
- ▲ Take Aim and shoot like an arrow your **PASSION** to hit the bullseye.

PASSION IS DIFFERENT TO ENTHUSIASM

- * Dictionary: **Enthusiasm** (aka - keen interest) is at the beginning of the scale, (just past curiosity).
- * **Passion** (extreme interest) is on the other end of the scale.
- ▲ There is a difference between **ENTHUSIASM** and **GODLY PASSION** although they do sometimes overlap.
- * **Enthusiasm** is more when we are excited about something at first and then **it loses its drive to continue**, especially in the face of disappointment, disillusionment, and the lack of progress.
- * The overall difference between **Godly passion** and being enthusiastic about a goal is that **passion never dies or goes away**. It can be ignored or doubted but it will return.
- * If you're passionate about something you want, that spark will never go out.

LET US BE PASSIONATE - WITH GOD'S PASSION AND DISCIPLINED TO DIRECT THAT PASSION TOWARDS THE GOD'S GOALS.